



“As of today, G20 constitutes more than 80 per cent of the global GDP. So, these are the most important countries in the world in terms of output”

SURESH PRABHU
FORMER UNION MINISTER
AND INDIA'S FORMER
SHERPA TO THE G20



“A major impact of India's G20 presidency is the recognition that digital public infrastructure is an inclusive and efficient way to provide public service delivery”

DEEPAK MISHRA
DIRECTOR AND CHIEF
EXECUTIVE, ICRIER



“Many of the global shared challenges playing out today—climate change, energy transition or supply chain diversification—cannot be solved by countries in isolation”

DEEPA KUMAR
HEAD, ASIA-PACIFIC
COUNTRY RISK, S&P GLOBAL
MARKET INTELLIGENCE

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are amongst the key issues highlighted by Finance Minister Sitharaman.

A WORK IN PROGRESS

The third G20 finance ministers' and central bank governors' meeting in Gandhinagar in July saw endorsements on many of these issues including the reform of MDBs and the Financial Stability Board's recommendations for the regulation and oversight of crypto-asset activities and markets. But, with the ongoing Russia-Ukraine war, the meeting ended without a consensus due to a lack of common language and only an outcome summary was released.

In fact, all eyes now are on whether a communiqué will be issued at the Leaders' Summit in September, which would make India's presidency of the G20 truly successful. Policy watchers are, however, optimistic that given India's diplomatic ties and its role in the previous Indonesian presidency, a communiqué at the Leaders' Summit is still very much possible.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist of Bank of Baroda, points out that G20 talks are all works in progress, which sometimes lead to an optimum solution. “To expect all 20 countries to agree to everything will not happen. But we need to have these kinds of discussions so that we can have consensus on at least some issues,” he says.

Kumar of ISID, however, notes that there was a serious question mark on last year's Indonesian G20 presidency coming up with a communiqué. But India came to the rescue. “Everybody had written off the Bali Summit as a failed one [that would] not come up with the communiqué. The Ukraine war was really a hot issue at that time. I think Prime Minister Modi's intervention helped to bridge the differences and find a language acceptable to all. This helped the communiqué to be agreed [upon] and adopted. So, even as a member of the troika and not the host country, India was able to help in finding a common ground. There is no reason why such a step will not be attempted this time around,” he says, adding that the PM's charisma and personal rapport with leaders of other G20 nations will help him to bring them around. The G20 troika consists of the current, previous and incoming presidencies, which work together to ensure consistency and continuity of the agenda. Italy held the presidency in 2021 and Indonesia in 2022.

But whatever be the final outcome, India has managed to set the agenda and get world leaders thinking about a new future. Read on to delve deeper into India's agenda for its G20 presidency and the progress made thus far. **BT**

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